

SURREY SCOUT

OCTOBER, 1980

No. 399

County Commissioner

My record cards for County and District appointments are usually made out in ink. On referring to Jim Elliot's card however I notice that I had left his address in pencil. This was because when he took over the duties of Assistant County Commissioner (Scouts) in March, 1978 he was planning to move back into Surrey from West Sussex. Unfortunately, but for a wide variety of understandable reasons, that move has not taken place. So, after two and a half years in this particular appointment, Jim has concluded that he cannot properly discharge from Eastbourne the responsibilities of an A.C.C. in Surrey.

I have reluctantly accepted Jim's resignation from the end of September, 1980 but, happily, he will continue to hold his "honourable charge" as a Leader Trainer and so will continue to be much in evidence with Basic and Advanced Courses at Bentley Copse elsewhere around the County.

Both Jim and I are delighted that John W. Brown, now Assistant District Commissioner (General) in Woking District, has accepted my invitation to take over from Jim as A.C.C. (Scouts) for Surrey with effect from 1st October, 1980. John's Scouting career has mainly been concerned with the Scout section at both Group and District level. He holds the Mountain Leadership Certificate and in 1975 went to the World Jamboree "Nordjamb" in Norway as an Assistant Troop Leader with the Surrey contingent led by Bruce Wood, A.C.C. (Venture Scouts). We wish him every success in this new appointment.

It also gives me great pleasure to announce that Lieutenant-General Sir David Scott-Barrett, K.B.E., M.C., has, at the invitation of our President, Lord Hamilton, kindly agreed to become President of the

Surrey Venture Scout Rifle Club in succession to the late Major-General E.H. Goulburn.

Sir David has had a distinguished Military career spanning a period of 38 years. He commanded the Scots Guards in 1942 and his later appointments included being General Officer Commanding Eastern District, G.O.C. Berlin and finally G.O.C. Scotland.

Sir David, who is in fact a near neighbour of John Brown, lives at Knaphill and is a frequent visitor to the Bisley Ranges. I am quite sure that with his active support and encouragement the Surrey Venture Scout Rifle Club will go from strength to strength.

We are indeed very fortunate in Surrey to have such a flourishing Rifle Club which is the only Scouting Rifle Club to be affiliated to the National Rifle Association. Practice shoots are held at Bisley regularly throughout the year under the supervision of qualified instructors and there is an annual competition which this year will be held on Sunday, 12th October. Last year's turnout for this competition was a record and I hope to see even more teams participating this year.

Indeed, as quite a number of new Venture Scout Units have been formed over the past year it is worth drawing attention to the fact that membership of the Club is open to all Venture Scouts and Ranger Guides in the County, either individually or as units, and also to Scout and Guide Leaders and members of the Scout Fellowship. Details of membership and of the Club programme can be obtained from the Club's Hon. Secretary, Mr. F.D. Harrison of 56 Manor Vale, Boston Manor Road, Brentford, Middlesex.

GORDON BATES

Scouts

After very careful consideration and with regret I have decided that I should give up the position of Assistant County Commissioner (Scouts). When I accepted the position some 2½ years ago, I had fully expected to be moving back into Surrey from Eastbourne, and that I would have the time to travel around the County, helping in the growth and work of the Section. However, I have decided to continue living down on the South Coast and feel that this makes me too remote for the regular contacts an A.C.C. should be developing in the County.

I have valued my association with Surrey Leaders and Scouts and hope that I have been able to help in some ways. This is not a time to reminisce, but I shall remember with pleasure quite a number of events and meetings, the principal being "SCOUT-OUT 79". It was marvellous to witness the way in which our Scouts entered into the spirit of the weekend, and I was most impressed by the support and

interest of so many people and kindred organisations. It really brought home to me how important it is to attract the maximum support in the prime task of providing our Scouts with enjoyable, challenging and worthwhile Scouting.

My thanks go to all the Leaders who have supported me since March 1978, and in particular to Brian Parker, Secretary of the County Scout Sub-committee. Brian is a tireless worker for the Scout Section and I have been extremely grateful for his willing and efficient support.

I am confident that the Scout Section in Surrey will develop well in the future under John Brown's leadership as A.C.C. (Scouts), and in wishing John all success as he takes up his appointment I would couple this by wishing all who work in the Scout Section continued success and satisfaction in the future.

JIM ELLIOT

County Chaplain

While on my holidays this year, I called for the weekend at the now famous ecumenical community at Taizé in France. Every week during the summer, over 2,000 young people from all over Europe go there to spend hours in reflection and prayer.

Taizé destroys the myth that religion today is only for the "oldies". Here we see very ordinary young people rising early in the morning for prayer together, and staying late into the night in the church to do the same.

Why is Taizé so different from many of our churches? Partly I think because so much effort is made to create the right atmosphere for prayer - verbally and materially. The church is decorated very simply, and dimly lit. There is a feeling of deep peace and the presence of God. One teenager said to me: "This place is really different; it feels like God is here".

What can we as Leaders take from this? I think

that we can all ask ourselves what effort we make to create the right atmosphere for prayer at the end of our meetings, or in our Scout Own services or church parades. Most boys cannot go straight from British Bulldog to the depths of prayer, and they need us to guide them carefully.

Perhaps we need to be more careful - by our introductory words, our tone of voice, even our posture - to create such an atmosphere. In our churches or at camp, even a few candles around a cross can make a lot of difference. My experience in primary and secondary schools, as well as in Scouting, suggests that all young people can go very deeply into prayer - if they receive the right guidance from us.

Of course, we must not stress "feelings" and "emotion" too much in prayer, but they are important. God is there all the time - but he often uses us to help the boys to feel his presence.

MICHAEL EVANS

Cub Scouts

At the last meeting of the County Cub Scout Sub-Committee held in June, one of the main subjects discussed was "Accidents". The discussion centred around the fact sheet "What Price Accidents" published by the Association and available free from the Resource Centre at Gilwell Park. Accidents cost in both human and financial terms and anything we can do to reduce them the better the Association will be. I strongly recommend that you obtain a copy and give the subject serious thought. Maybe, it is a subject that could be raised at your next Group Scouters meeting. Here are the opening paragraphs:-

"never happened before"

"Nobody remembered who first rigged the climbing

rope from a roof beam at the Group Headquarters. It was used most Troop nights and filled many a gap in the activity programme. It was best of all for a fast and furious game which meant sprinting up and swinging Tarzan style to touch down as far as possible at the other end of the hall.

That was until the rope snapped and a boy had to go to hospital with concussion and a broken arm. Nobody had thought about the rope chaffing where it joined the beam so there was no regular checking. After all, it never happened before!

That is the trouble with accidents; they happen when least expected. In Scouting, in particular, they most occur in ordinary everyday situations".

STEVE HALL

Courses

General Information Courses

Woking	12th October
Wallington	19th October
Reigate	16th November

Scout Fellowship

Leatherhead	30th November
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Basic Courses

CUB SCOUT LEADERS

Reigate	6th/7th December 1980
Staines	24th/25th January 1981
Purley	14th/15th February 1981
Surbiton	14th/15th March 1981

SCOUT LEADERS

Bentley Copse	11th/12th October (Residential)
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Croydon	7th/8th February 1981
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BASIC VENTURE SCOUT LEADERS

Bentley Copse	7th/8th March & 10th May
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Advanced Courses

CUB SCOUT LEADERS

Any interest in a non residential during the winter should be notified to

G.S.L./COMMISSIONERS

Bentley Copse	4th/5th October plus 22nd/23rd November
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Water Activities Supervisory Skills Course

	11th/12th October
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Pack Holiday Course

Bentley Copse	18th/19th October
Polyapes	11th/12th April 1981

Mrs. D. Martin, 103 Lovelace Drive, Pyrford, Woking.
Mrs. E. Morgan, 27 Barrow Avenue, Carshalton.
Mrs. M. Leppard, 24 Colman Way, Redhill.

E.J. Mackie, 30 Morton Road, East Grinstead.

R. Penford, 49 Wolverton Gardens, Horley.
F. Kitchener, 19 Lime Wood Close, St. Johns, Woking
D. Brown, 21 Longsmead, Blindley Heath.
Miss M. Pooley, 71 Beech Grove, Mitcham.

D. Barker, 3 Oriental Close, Woking.

W.H. Smith, 266 Whitehorse Lane, London SE25.

B.C. Wood, 18 Sole Farm Road, Gt. Bookham.

Mrs. W. Viner, 58 West Bank, Dorking.

D.R. Barrell, 1 Beech Road, Reigate.

Information from J. Forbat, 46 Firlands, Ellesmere Road, Weybridge.

Mrs. W. Viner, 58 West Bank, Dorking.
Miss M. Pooley, 71 Beech Grove, Mitcham.

Leader Training

Leaders who have attended County based adult Leader Courses during the 15 years since Greater London South West Scout County was formed from parts of Surrey and Middlesex, will know that during that time courses have been organised by one Training Team whose members hold Leader Warrants issued by the two Counties - a fairly unique situation in the U.K. The result has been that unlike many parts of the Country few courses have been cancelled for lack of support and the team has been able to develop a "back up" team of helpers, and mount courses wherever the demands were greatest throughout the Counties. At regular intervals, we have reviewed the effectiveness of the arrangements in the light of changing demands for courses and the re-structuring of some of them. As much as possible, team members have been fairly evenly spread geographically throughout both Counties although prepared to go anywhere to arrange courses and the team has increased in size to 17.

During recent weeks, many will have heard that changes are to be introduced in the initial and basic stages of Leader training which are designed to give adults new to a leader role even better opportunities to equip themselves for their chosen responsibilities than exist at present, and the Districts will be able to improve their role in these training stages. The new procedures will be introduced stage by stage throughout 1981 without interruption to the number of courses offered within the County and Leaders are recommended not to await these develop-

ments but apply for whichever of the courses published in "Surrey Scout" fit in with their availabilities.

In order to maximise co-operation between District and County training teams the County Commissioners of Surrey and Greater London South West have agreed that rather than expand the existing team any further, it would be more advantageous for G.L.S.W. to form its own team using some of the present members and then recruiting from within that County. The new team will come into existence in January 1981 and work in close co-operation with the Surrey team until it has developed sufficient resources to provide all the courses required within G.L.S.W. Like so many other activities, such as Air, Water and Extension Scouting, co-operation will continue between the two teams for as long as is necessary to provide effective training for Leaders.

As a first step to the setting up of the G.L.S.W. team, I am delighted to report that Howard Smith, who completed the Advanced Trainers Course at Gilwell some months ago and is being appointed a Leader Trainer, has also accepted the C.C.s invitation to become A.C.C. (Leader Training) for G.L.S.W. Howard and I have worked together on training courses for many years and we shall co-operate closely during the coming months in the setting up of a strong G.L.S.W. team. Keep your eye on these columns for news of future developments but contact any of the Course Leaders if you need training during the next few months!

DAVID BARRELL

Grant Aid

Run out of Funds

How frustrating it can be when work on that new headquarters has to be held up or that extension cannot be finished because the ready cash has been used up.

The programme so painstakingly planned has to be postponed, proving a great disappointment to all members of the Group.

It was precisely to cater for these situations that the County Development and International Fund was brought into being. Financial help is available from this Fund which is administered by the County Executive Committee.

Full particulars and procedures are detailed in the Yellow Pages of the County Directory.

So if you have a worthwhile project, turn to the Yellow Pages and develop it!

Pieces and Bits

Frylands Patrol Camp

Following a pilot scheme at Tolmers National Scout Camp in 1979, Frylands Wood operated a similar scheme this Summer. The Frylands Wood Patrol Camp, as it was called, was aimed at Scout Patrols who wanted to camp without Leaders.

For the last two weeks in August, voluntary staff ran a programme of activities; climbing, abseiling, archery, swimming, leathercraft, carving, pioneering and many other activities during the day, followed by evening activities which included: campfires, hikes, talks, slideshows, film shows and competitions.

The scheme was a great success with boys from as far away as South Wales taking part. The majority of campers arrived as conventional Patrols but there were Scout Troops who used the event as their Summer Camp, Venture Units who wanted a base for a camp in the London area, boys camping by themselves and small groups of friends who were not from the same Scout Troop. Hopefully, the scheme will be continued next year. Certainly it was obvious that both boys and Leaders enjoyed it enormously - some even writing to the Warden, John Gailey, to thank his staff for their efforts.

If you would like to know more about the Camp or can offer your services as a member of the Camp Staff next August, please write or telephone The Warden, Frylands Wood National Scout Camp Site, Featherbed Lane, Addington Croydon CR0 9AA. Telephone 01 657 1154.

Lost property

Readers of "Surrey Scout" may remember that a few months ago we published the fact that Godalming District had 'mislaid' its marquee - we wondered how anyone can 'mislay' such an item. Quite easily it seems because - to prove it no fluke - it's

been lost again! And Banstead have joined the fun, for part of that District's marquee has gone missing, as well.

Lee Abbey Christian Leadership Weekend Course

A Lee Abbey Weekend Course for Scouters and Guiders is to be held at Ashburnham Place, Battle, Sussex, from Friday, November 21st., to Sunday, November 23rd., (4.00 p.m.) 1980. The cost will be £15.50, excluding VAT, but including a £5.00 non-returnable registration fee. Single room £1.50 extra. Accommodation is also available for wives and husbands and families (children under 13 years half price). Full details, including a special leaflet and application form, may be obtained from the Secretary, Lee Abbey, LYNTON, Devon. EX35 6JJ.

Let My People Grow: Spiritual Development in Guiding and Scouting.

This is the theme of this year's United Reformed Church Guide and Scout Fellowship conference on October 4th, 1980 at Baden-Powell House, London. A warm welcome is extended to anyone over 14 who is interested in attending. (The conference is open to anyone; there's no need to belong to URCSF, or to the URC). The conference leader is Prof. Walter James of the Open University. He is also Chairman of the Scout Religious Advisory Board, and of the Working Party on Spiritual Development, and was Adviser on Education to the Assembly of the World Council of Churches in 1975. The cost per head is £3.00. This includes all refreshments and a cooked lunch.

Uniform is usually worn by those who have. Send your cheque/PO to Sam Morton, 32 Burlington Road, Isleworth, Middlesex, making cheques payable to the "United Reformed Church Guide and Scout Fellowship."

International County Directory

Just a gentle reminder to those who have not yet had a chance to return their "report back" forms that I would like them as soon as convenient.

Many of you will not have an opportunity of going abroad in 1981 but this need not stop you from including the international aspect of Scouting in your programme. There are many ways in which this can be done. The International Scout and Guide Club meet regularly at Baden Powell House and details are published in "Scouting" magazine. Have you considered a visit to the Commonwealth Institute? Do you know with which foreign towns you are twinned? Can you invite someone from abroad to talk to your Pack, Troop, Unit? Have any of your members considered having a foreign pen friend? Is anybody in your area a radio ham? (they are undoubtedly in touch with people abroad). Have you considered the international aspect of stamp and coin collecting? How about a fancy dress evening with national costumes, perhaps followed by a simple but foreign menu? There is no end to the ideas and I would be very pleased to hear about any successful meetings which have been held along these lines.

TERRY MAGGS

Extension

Thanks to an anonymous Scouter in Staines the County now has a caravan for use by Groups with handicapped boys enrolled. It is a sturdy, snug three berth van with all mod. cons. fitted with standard 50 mm towing ball and bar and weighing 16 cwt.

It is available for use by boys not able to sleep on grass or in tents, or by Scouters as an H.Q. when in camp with handicapped boys. Do you have a boy who could not attend camp because he could not sleep in a tent? This could be an answer.

The van is stationed on the 1st Burwood Park Group's site in Chargate Close, Burwood Park, Walton-on-Thames.

Bookings to me please.

PAUL GREEN

County

A.C.C. (Scouts). Delete J.M. Elliot

Insert J.W. Brown, 67 Lane End Drive, Knap-hill, Woking GU21 2OG. Telephone Brookwood 4492.

President, Surrey Venture Scout Rifle Club

Insert Lt-Gen. Sir David Scott-Barrett, K.B.E., M.C., The White House, Littlewick Common, Knaphill, Woking. Telephone Brookwood 4198

County Diary

October

6	Scout Sub-Committee	Leatherhead
11	Chief Scout Award Presentation	Banstead
12	Surrey Venture Scout Rifle Club Annual Shoot	Bisley
13	Cub Scout Sub-Committee	Leatherhead
14	Programme & Training Sub-Committee	Bookham
15	Executive Committee	London
26	Venture Scout Cooking Competition	
27	County Chaplain's Meeting	Dorking
28	Scout Fellowship Sub-Committee	Ew

November

1	Swimming Gala	Guildford
8	District Commissioners' Symposium	

15-16 Venture Competition

December

2	Water Activities Sub-Committee	Staines
4	Venture Scout Sub-Committee	Dorking

November "Surrey Scout"

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